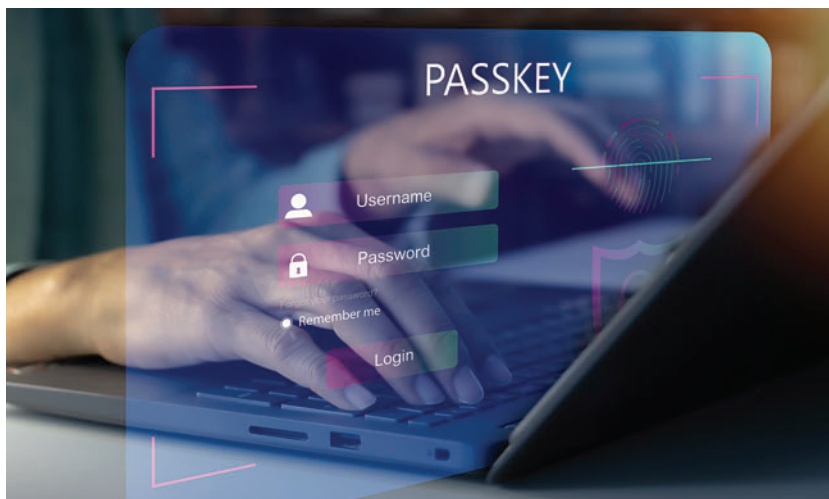




is fairly simple: fewer lockouts, fewer “forgot password” loops, less phishing risk, and a smoother login experience that feels as easy as unlocking your smartphone on the daily

For India specifically, there’s an extra angle. We’ve leaned hard on OTPs for years, but OTPs have very obvious weaknesses – delays, SIM-swap scams, and the fact that people treat them very casually because they’re everywhere. Passkeys push authentication back onto the device, which can be both more secure and more user-friendly when implemented well.

You won’t wake up one day and find passwords to have become extinct. But you will notice that more apps nudging you: “Enable passkey for easier sign-in.” And once you try it, going back to passwords feels like choosing a dial-up modem in a 5G world.

Smart homes are growing up: Longevity and security become key features

The early smart-home era was about novelty: smart lights, smart speakers, smart everything. The 2026 smart-home era is more about maturity: support timelines, security updates, repairability, and whether your gadgets will still continue to work when the brand’s cloud service gets bored.

Consumers are also asking the tougher questions now:

- How long will this device get software updates?
- What happens if the company shuts down a server?
- Can I repair it, or is it glued into a landfill?

This is where regulation and market pressure start pushing in the same direction. Support duration and security are becoming buying criteria, not afterthoughts. Standards like Matter also help by reducing the chance that a device becomes orphaned inside a single app ecosystem.

In India, where appliances traditionally last forever and repair culture is very strong, this shift is overdue. The “smart” part of smart home tech has to include durability – not just flashy features.

AI PCs go mainstream: NPU is new core count

For years, laptop shopping was a familiar checklist: CPU generation, RAM, SSD, display, and whether the brand was quietly cutting corners on the charger. In 2026, there’s a new spec that has started mattering to normal people too: the NPU (Neural Processing Unit) – a dedicated chip block that runs AI features locally, without constantly pinging the cloud.

Why is this suddenly a “real” trend and not just marketing fluff? Because analysts are already projecting that NPU-powered “AI Advanced PCs” will make up a majority of the global PC shipments in 2026 – meaning this isn’t just another niche anymore, it’s where the industry is heading.

What changes for users is subtle but rather useful: you get faster on-device features (noise removal, live captions, image enhancement, smarter search), better battery efficiency for those AI tasks, and in many cases better privacy because more processing can happen locally on your machine.

In India, it also reshapes the value conversation. When a laptop costs more, buyers will ask: Is the AI capability actually built in, or is it just a software sticker? 2026 is when “AI-ready” stops being another buzzword and becomes a spec that you can compare – like graphics, but for everyday work.

